Membership is at a record. Isn't everything fine?

APRA data · June 2007 to June 2026

Not quite. A record 12.8 million people hold hospital cover, but since June 2015 Australia's population has grown faster than membership. The share covered, 45.8%, is still below its June 2015 peak of 47.4%.

People with hospital cover · June 2026
12,823,752
Up 40.2% since June 2007

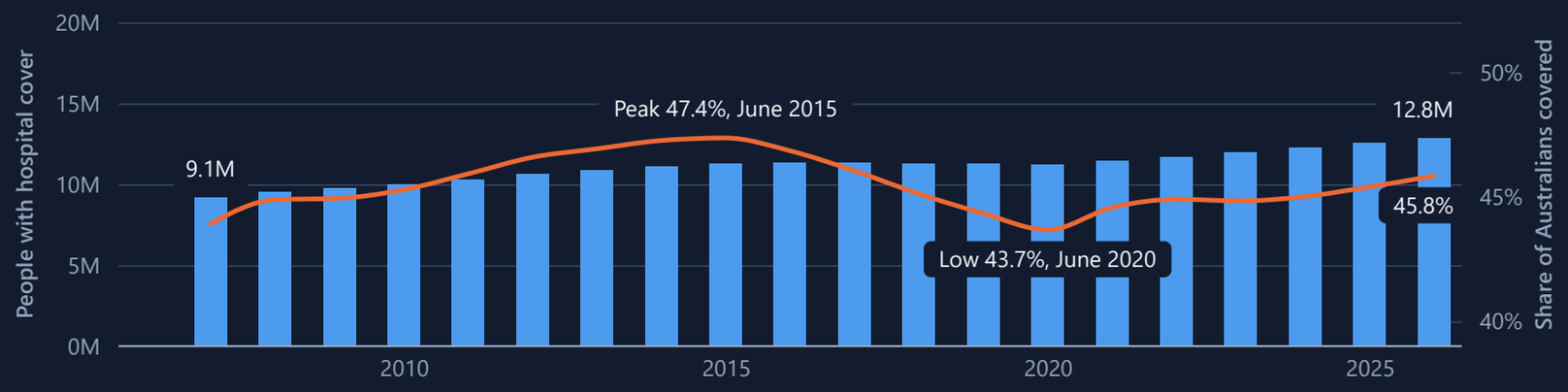
Change on a year earlier · June 2026
+292,743
Up 2.3% on June 2025

Share of Australians covered · June 2026
45.8%
Peak 47.4% in June 2015

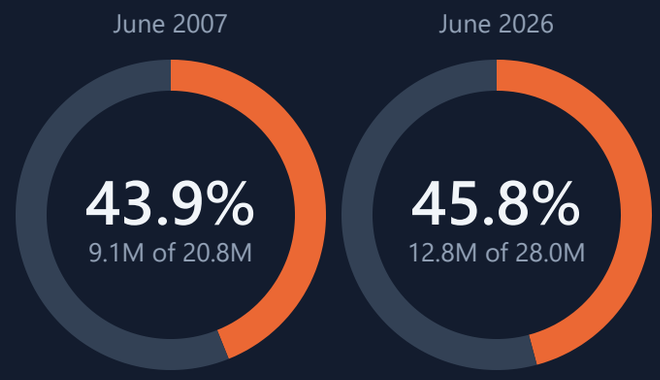
Hospital policies · June 2026
6,268,336
Up 43.5% since June 2007

A record 12.8 million people have hospital cover, but the share of Australians covered is still below its 2015 peak

People with hospital cover at each June (columns, left axis) and the share of the population they make up (line, right axis, 39% to 52%).



The slice of Australians covered moved from 43.9% to 45.8%, while the people in it grew from 9.1M to 12.8M



How the numbers work

Coverage is people with hospital cover divided by Australia's population.

People, policies and population are counted at the end of each quarter, so a period's figure is its latest quarter, never a sum.

Every figure traces back to a cell in APRA's spreadsheets. The five published figures on the right were rebuilt from them and match at the precision they were published.

5 of 5 published figures reproduced from APRA's raw data

Measure	Published	Rebuilt	Source	Match
Hospital cover at ages 25–29, June 2025	26.3%	26.258%	CHOICE	✓ Yes
Hospital cover, share of population, December 2025	45.6%	45.648%	CHOICE	✓ Yes
Hospital cover, share of population, June 2025	45.39%	45.3923%	APRA	✓ Yes
Hospital policies with an excess or co-payment, June 2018	84%	83.60%	ACCC	✓ Yes
Hospital policies with exclusions, June 2018	44%	43.84%	ACCC	✓ Yes

Source: APRA quarterly private health insurance statistics, June 2026 release, and annual membership and benefits statistics 2024–25. Population: ABS, as published by APRA. Figures, titles and takeaways are computed from the data and update with each release. Latest release: June 2026.

github.com/Nandita-choudhary/phi-coverage

Are people downgrading instead of leaving?

APRA data · June 2007 to June 2026

In aggregate, yes. Policies grew 43.5% since June 2007, but only 26.8% now give full cover, down from 63.6%. And 29.4% carry an excess over 500 dollars, up from 0.5% before the April 2019 rule change.

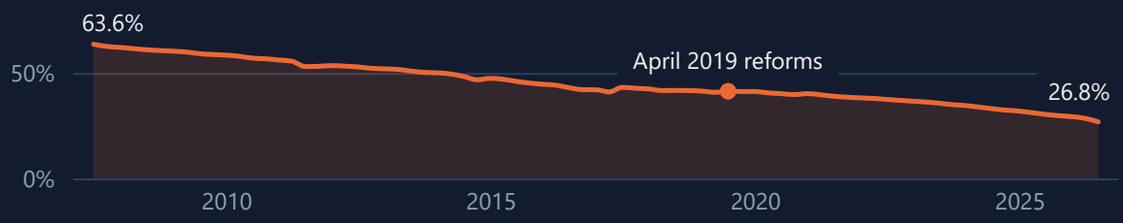
Hospital policies · June 2026
6,268,336
Up 43.5% since June 2007

With full cover · June 2026
26.8%
Down from 63.6% in June 2007

With an excess over 500 dollars · June 2026
29.4%
Up from 0.5% in March 2019

Policies grew 43.5% since June 2007, but only 26.8% now give full cover, down from 63.6%

Share of hospital policies with full cover, at the end of each quarter.



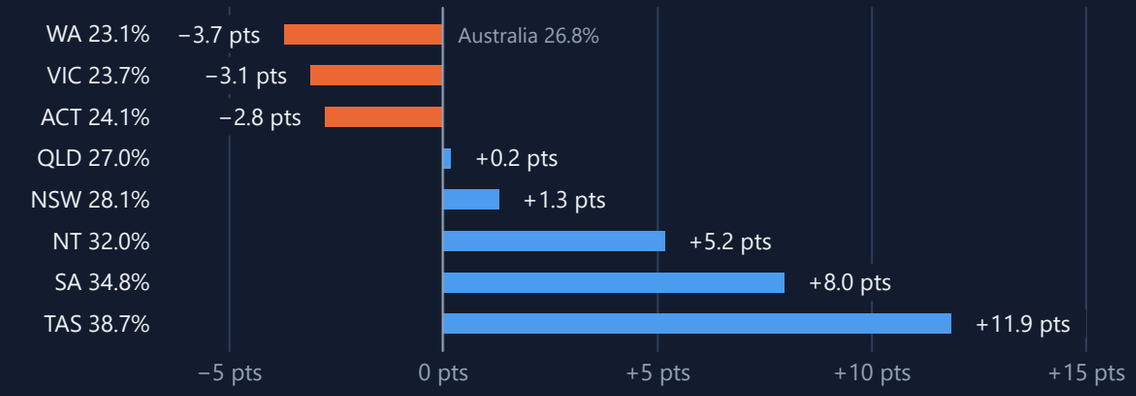
Since the April 2019 rule change, policies with an excess over 500 dollars went from 0.5% to 29.4%

Share of hospital policies with an excess over 500 dollars (single), from September 2010.



Full cover is rarest in Western Australia and most common in Tasmania: 3.7 points below and 11.9 above the national 26.8%

Share of hospital policies with full cover, latest quarter, each state against Australia as a whole.



What less cover means

Exclusions: treatments a policy does not pay for at all.
Reduced cover: treatments a policy pays only reduced benefits for.
Excess: what you pay towards a hospital admission before the insurer pays.

Before you renew, check your exclusions and your excess.

Full cover means no exclusions and no reduced cover. APRA counts the mix of policies at each quarter end, not who switched, so thinner cover can come from members downgrading or from new members buying less. In the excess chart, quarters before September 2010 are left out: the share drops 4.1 points that quarter, and APRA's notes do not explain why.

Source: APRA quarterly private health insurance statistics, June 2026 release, and annual membership and benefits statistics 2024–25. Population: ABS, as published by APRA. Figures, titles and takeaways are computed from the data and update with each release. Latest release: June 2026.

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Is the pool getting older?

APRA data · June 2007 to June 2026

Yes. By June 2025, people aged 65 and over made up 20.7% of the insured, up from 13.3% in June 2007. Across Australia the share rose less, from 13.1% to 17.4%.

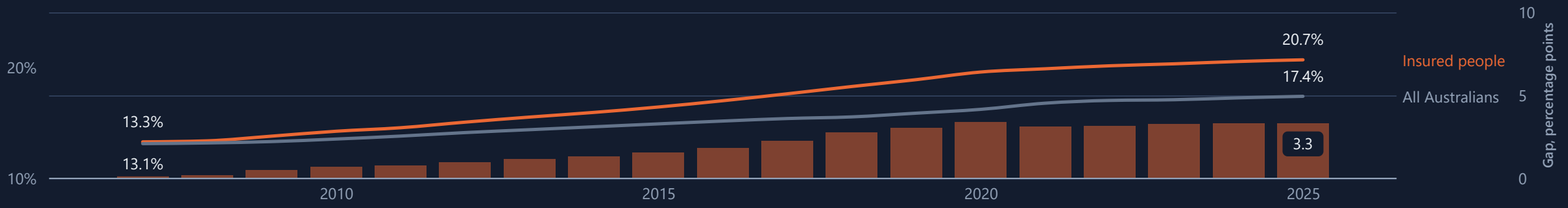
Insured people aged 65+ · June 2025
20.7%
Up from 13.3% in June 2007

All Australians aged 65+ · June 2025
17.4%
Up from 13.1% in June 2007

Gap, percentage points · June 2025
3.3
Up from 0.2 points in June 2007

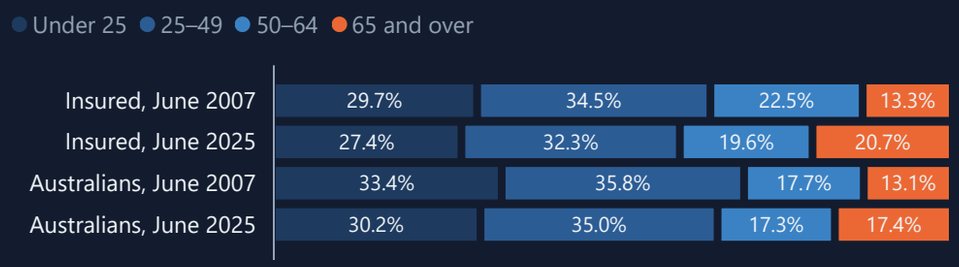
Insured people are ageing faster than Australia: aged 65+ rose from 13.3% to 20.7% of the insured, against 13.1% to 17.4% of everyone

Share of people aged 65 or over, each June (lines, left axis), and the gap between them in percentage points (columns, right axis).



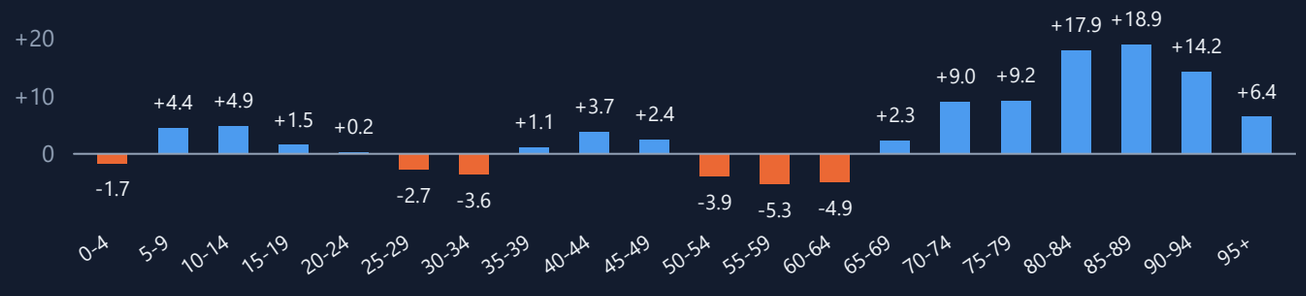
Every age group under 65 shrank as a share of the insured; 65 and over grew from 13.3% to 20.7%

Share of people in each age group, June 2007 and June 2025: people with hospital cover against all Australians.



Coverage rose most among 85–89-year-olds, up 18.9 points since June 2007, and fell among 0–4, 25–29, 30–34, 50–54, 55–59 and 60–64-year-olds

Change in the share of each age band with hospital cover, June 2007 to June 2025, percentage points. National figures.



These figures are for Australia as a whole: APRA's population by age has no state breakdown. In June 2018 its population table lacks women aged 95+, so Australia's 65+ share is slightly understated that year. Population by age is published once a year, to June 2025.

Source: APRA quarterly private health insurance statistics, June 2026 release, and annual membership and benefits statistics 2024–25. Population: ABS, as published by APRA. Figures, titles and takeaways are computed from the data and update with each release. Latest release: June 2026.

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